From Farmland to Factory Floor:
Globalization, Identity, and Youth in Bharuch District, Gujarat

Subject: Approaches to Globalization - HM-467

Students: Dhyey Parekh (202303007) & Chirag Katkoriya (202301259)

1. Background

Bharuch district, Gujarat, began its industrial journey in the 1970s and has since evolved into India's *Chemical Capital*, hosting ∼1,394 industrial units across six clusters—Ankleshwar, Panoli, Jhagadia, Dahej, Saykha, and Vilayat. Today, Bharuch alone contributes **19%** of India's chemical exports, with global companies exporting to the US, Brazil, Japan, the Netherlands, and South Africa. Bharuch's story is not just one of industrial output—it is a living case study of how globalization reshapes everyday life in a mid-size Indian district. This rapid industrialisation, driven by successive waves of global investment, has quietly transformed the social and cultural fabric of the district—yet its impact on the *lives and identities of young people* remains largely undocumented.

2. Objectives

- Trace how forces of globalization entered and transformed Bharuch since the 1970s.
- Examine how global trends in **work and food** have shaped the everyday lives of Bharuch's youth.
- Understand how young people negotiate between local Gujarati identity and global cultural influences.

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